

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Cowardly 'act of hate'

Police dig in after drive-by attack at River North album release party kills 4 and wounds 14 others

Johnson, other officials decry violence in wake of one of city's worst shootings in recent years



Chicago police detectives Thursday investigate a mass shooting where four people were killed and 14 were wounded late Wednesday in the 300 block of West Chicago Avenue in the River North neighborhood of Chicago. **PETER TSAI/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Caroline Kubzansky, Sam Charles, Lauryn Azu and Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

Late Wednesday night, assailants armed with at least one rifle rolled up outside an album release party for a local drill rapper in River North and opened fire on a crowd gathered on the sidewalk.

Within a matter of seconds, police Superintendent Larry Snelling said, the attackers were able to shoot an astonishing 18 people, killing four in a spot close to the center of the city as Chicago is preparing for the holiday weekend and playing host to a high-profile NASCAR road race.

The shooting was among the city's worst in recent years and served as a warning that even though violent crime has fallen in recent years, gun violence — especially that fueled by rivalries on Chicago's splintered gang landscape — remains stubbornly persistent.

"Shootings like these are a tragic reminder of how far we still have to go as a city," Mayor Brandon Johnson said during a news conference on Thursday, calling the incident a cowardly "act of hate."

City and state officials decried the mass shooting while calling it an isolated incident and asking citizens to send in information to investigators.

Family members of those killed spoke out against further violence, saying that retribution won't bring back their loved ones.

"I don't want another death," said Andrea Williamson, whose son Devonte was killed and leaves behind a 3-year-old daughter. "That's not going to bring my son back. I want the people who did it to get caught."

Patrons were hit outside the Artis Restaurant and Lounge, which had been rented out for a private event, police said.

Local rapper Mello Buckzz, whose name is Melanie Doyle, according to court records, had planned the party, according to social media. Messages to Doyle and her attorney were not immediately returned.

For the past 15 years, Chicago's drill rap scene has often been linked to fatal gun violence as rival artists with reputed gang ties trade insults and threats through their lyrics and social media taunts.

Police officials did not offer a motive, citing the pending investigation, but said it was clear that the venue was targeted.

"This wasn't some random

Turn to Shooting, Page 2

House GOP sends tax bill to Trump

Democratic leader's speech lambasting measure sets record

By Lisa Mascaro, Mary Clare Jalonick and Leah Askarinam
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — House Republicans propelled President Donald Trump's big trillion dollar tax breaks and spending cuts bill to final passage Thursday in Congress, overcoming multiple setbacks to approve his signature second-term policy package before a Fourth of July deadline.

The tight vote, 218-214, came at a potentially high political cost, with two Republicans joining all Democrats opposed. GOP leaders worked overnight and the president himself leaned on a handful of skeptics to drop their opposition and send the bill to him to sign into law. Democratic leader Hakeem Jeffries of New York delayed voting for more than eight hours by seizing control of the floor with a record-breaking speech against the bill.



Speaker of the House Mike Johnson holds up the final vote tally while celebrating the passage of President Donald Trump's signature bill of tax breaks and spending cuts. **CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY**

"Are you tired of winning yet?" said House Speaker Mike Johnson, R-La., invoking Trump as he called the vote.

"With one big beautiful bill, we are going to make this country stronger, safer and more prosperous than ever before."

Republicans celebrated with a

rendition of the Village People's "Y.M.C.A.," a song the president often plays at his rallies, during a ceremony afterward.

The outcome delivers a milestone for the GOP and the president, by his Friday goal. Trump is

Turn to Bill, Page 9

Immigrants face how to celebrate in divided nation

President's mass deportation efforts put chill on holiday

By Sophie Levenson, William Tong and Alexandra Kukulka
Chicago Tribune

The four women sat in camping chairs on 19th Street sipping mix-made mojitos. One was knitting, another talked on her cellphone. Amalia Alejo sang in Spanish and Ana Flores held onto her small white dog.

They looked at home because

they were. They sat right outside Flores' house in Pilsen, laughing as the sun beat down on the quiet Tuesday afternoon, three days before the Fourth of July.

Around the corner, one of Pilsen's murals, painted by Hector Duarte, takes up nearly a whole block. In the painting, barbed wire snakes around a prostrate Mexican man wearing a white mask. His eyes ask for help. Flores said the picture is meant to represent Mexican immigration to the United States.

"We appreciate, as immigrants,

Turn to Immigrants, Page 4

At odds over area's paratransit service

Pace program allows disabled people to use rideshares, but labor sees it as a way to outsource jobs. **Business**

Most losses record on rocky ground

The White Sox's record of 121 losses may not last long as the Rockies are on pace to drop 126 games. **Chicago Sports**

